ATLAS
RETAIL BANK

Atlas Retail Bank, N.A.
1450 Harborview Avenue, Baltimore, MD 21202
www.atlasretailbank.example

HUMAN RESOURCES · ATL-HR-001

Employee Handbook & Code of Ethics

Standards of conduct, employment practices and benefits for Atlas associates

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Effective date	2026-01-01	**Next review**	2027-01-01
Policy owner	Tanya Brooks, Chief Human Resources Officer	**Approved by**	Board of Directors, Compensation & Human Capital Committee
Applies to	All Atlas Financial Holdings associates, temporary workers and contractors	**Classification**	Internal

1. Our purpose and values

Atlas Retail Bank has served communities from Maine to Florida since 1927. Our purpose is **to help families and small businesses on the East Coast build financial strength**. Our values are: - **Integrity:** do the right thing, especially when no one is watching. - **Customer first:** recommend only what genuinely meets the customer's needs. - **Respect:** value every colleague and customer. - **Stewardship:** protect the bank's safety and soundness and our customers' trust.

2. Employment eligibility and screening

- All offers depend on a background check, credit check (where permitted by state law) and **fingerprinting under Section 19 of the Federal Deposit Insurance Act**. Anyone convicted of a crime involving dishonesty, breach of trust or money laundering cannot be employed without FDIC consent.
- Credit history is not used for hiring in states and cities that restrict it (e.g. New York City, Connecticut, Maryland, Washington DC), except where a legal exemption applies.
- Form I-9 employment eligibility is verified within 3 business days of hire.
- Loan originators are registered with the NMLS before taking any mortgage applications.

3. Equal employment opportunity

Atlas is an equal opportunity employer. We make decisions about employment without regard to: - race, colour, religion or creed - sex (including pregnancy), sexual orientation or gender identity - national origin, age,

disability or genetic information - veteran status, marital status - any other characteristic protected by federal, state or local law

Reasonable accommodations are provided for disability, pregnancy and religious practice.

4. Working hours and pay

Role group	Standard hours	FLSA status
Branch associates (tellers, personal bankers)	40 hrs/week, incl. some Saturdays	Non-exempt (overtime at 1.5x after 40 hrs; daily overtime where state law requires)
Branch managers	40+ hrs/week	Exempt
Contact centre (Baltimore, Charlotte)	37.5 hrs/week shifts; 24/7 fraud desk	Non-exempt
Corporate functions	40 hrs/week, hybrid eligible	Exempt / non-exempt by role

Atlas's minimum pay is **USD 22 per hour** for all associates, or the local minimum wage if higher. Pay is bi-weekly by direct deposit.

Branch hours (standard)

Mon-Thu 9:00-17:00, Fri 9:00-18:00, Sat 9:00-13:00 (selected branches). Hours vary by state and branch; see the branch locator.

5. Leave and time off

- **Paid time off:** 18 days per year in years 1-4, 23 days in years 5-9, and 28 days from year 10.
- **Bank holidays:** the 11 Federal Reserve holidays.
- **Sick leave:** at least the amount required by state or local law (e.g. NY Paid Sick Leave, NJ Earned Sick Leave, MD Healthy Working Families Act). Atlas standard is 7 days.
- **Parental leave:** 16 weeks fully paid for birth, adoption or foster placement.
- **FMLA** and state family-leave programmes (NY PFL, NJ FLI, MA PFML, CT PFML, MD FAMLI) are coordinated with Atlas pay.
- **Mandatory consecutive leave:** associates in sensitive roles (cash, wires, lending approvals, IT administration) must take **10 consecutive business days** off each year. This is a fraud-prevention control.

6. Code of ethics

6.1 Sales practices

- Accounts or products may only be opened with the customer's **informed consent**, documented in the system.
- Atlas does not set product sales quotas for branch associates. Incentives are balanced across customer satisfaction, compliance and quality, and are clawed back if misconduct is found.

- Opening unauthorised accounts, inflating sales or pressuring customers is grounds for termination and may be reported to regulators.

6.2 Conflicts of interest

- Associates may not process transactions on their own accounts, or on the accounts of family members or close associates.
- Outside employment and board seats need pre-approval from Compliance.
- Loans to executive officers and directors follow **Regulation O** limits and Board approval rules.

6.3 Gifts and entertainment

Gifts from customers or vendors may not exceed **USD 100 per year** per source. The **Bank Bribery Act** (18 U.S.C. 215) makes it a federal crime to corruptly accept anything of value in connection with bank business. Report any offer above the limit to Compliance.

6.4 Personal trading

Associates with access to material non-public information must pre-clear securities trades, and may not trade in Atlas Financial Holdings stock during blackout periods.

6.5 Confidentiality

Customer information is protected under the **Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act**. Access only what you need for your job. Browsing celebrity or colleague accounts is prohibited and monitored.

7. Mandatory training

Course	Frequency
Code of Ethics attestation	Annual
BSA/AML & OFAC	Annual (role-based advanced modules for high-risk roles)
Fair Lending & UDAAP	Annual
Information Security & Phishing	Annual + quarterly phishing simulations
Privacy (GLBA)	Annual
Elder Financial Exploitation	Annual for customer-facing staff
Robbery & branch security	Annual for branch staff (Bank Protection Act)

8. Performance, discipline and separation

- Performance reviews are held mid-year and at year-end. Compliance behaviour is a "gate": a serious compliance failure caps the rating.
- Corrective action steps are coaching, a written warning, a final warning and termination. Fraud, theft and wilful policy breaches may result in immediate termination.
- On separation, system access is removed **the same business day**, and keys, badges and tokens are collected.

9. Ethics hotline and non-retaliation

- **Atlas EthicsLine:** 1-800-555-0119 (24/7, independent provider) or ethicsline.atlasretailbank.example
- Reports can be anonymous. Retaliation is prohibited and protected under Sarbanes-Oxley and Dodd-Frank whistleblower provisions.
- Associates may report concerns directly to regulators (OCC, CFPB, SEC) without notifying Atlas.

10. Acknowledgement

Each associate must acknowledge this handbook within 30 days of hire and annually in Workday.

Atlas Retail Bank is a fictional bank created for AI training and demonstration. It is not a real financial institution and its deposits are not FDIC-insured. All names, addresses and numbers are invented.